

Retail Sales Dashboard — User Guide

VEDA Technology Internship • Task 3
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1. Purpose of the Dashboard

This interactive dashboard provides a concise overview of retail sales performance. It summarizes key sales metrics and compares sales across **location** and **product category**. The design is intended to help a stakeholder quickly understand overall sales activity and identify differences between categories and sales channels.

2. How to Read the Dashboard

Dashboard element	What it tells you
Total Sales	Overall sales generated in the dataset. The displayed value is approximately 1.62M .
Units Sold	Total quantity of products sold. The dashboard displays approximately 70K units .
Total Transactions	Number of transactions represented in the dataset, shown as approximately 13K .
Average Transaction Value	Average sales amount per transaction, displayed as 128.64 .
Sales by Location	Compares Online and In-store sales. The dashboard shows about 822.43K Online and 795.17K In-store .
Sales by Category	Compares total sales across product categories. Taller bars represent categories with higher total sales.

Reading tip: Start with the four cards for the overall picture, then use the location and category visuals to understand where the sales are coming from. If slicers/filters are present in the Power BI file, apply them to view the same metrics for a selected subset of the data.

3. Dashboard Design Rationale

The dashboard keeps the number of headline metrics limited so that the most important information is visible immediately. Cards are used for high-level numerical summaries, while charts are used for category and location comparisons. The consistent blue-and-white visual theme improves readability and keeps attention on the data.

4. Interview Questions & Answers

Q1. How do you decide which KPIs belong on a dashboard vs. in a detailed report?

Answer: I select KPIs based on the stakeholder's main business questions and decisions. A dashboard should contain a small set of high-value metrics that can be understood quickly, such as total sales, units sold, transaction count, or average transaction value. Detailed breakdowns, supporting calculations, data-quality information, and less frequently used metrics are more appropriate for a detailed report.

Q2. What makes a dashboard 'interactive' rather than just a static chart?

Answer: An interactive dashboard allows the user to change the view or filter the data and see the visuals update dynamically. Examples include slicers, filters, drill-down, tooltips, cross-filtering, and clickable chart elements. A static chart only presents a fixed view of the data.

Q3. How would you design a dashboard differently for an executive vs. an operations manager?

Answer: For an executive, I would emphasize a small number of high-level KPIs, trends, major business segments, and exceptions that support strategic decisions. For an operations manager, I would provide more operational detail, such as category-level performance, transaction patterns, location/channel comparisons, and filters that help investigate specific issues. The underlying data can be the same, but the level of detail and the decisions supported by the dashboard would differ.

5. Tools Used

Power BI was used to create the interactive dashboard and visualizations. The dashboard is based on the cleaned retail sales data prepared during the earlier data-cleaning stage.